

Personalized Resume Interview Q&A

Present your real experience clearly: explain the situation, your responsibility, the action or control you performed, and the business outcome.

1. Tell me about yourself - detailed interview introduction (90-120 seconds).

ANSWER

I believe that "Life is not about finding yourself; it is about creating yourself." This mindset has helped me continuously learn, adapt, and grow throughout my career. I started my career with CAMS, where I worked for around 1.5 years in financial operations. During this period, I gained hands-on experience in KYC verification, MIS reporting, Microsoft Excel, and operational processes, which gave me a strong foundation in financial services. Later, I joined Cameo Corporate Services, where I worked on IPO processing, Rights Issues, Buybacks, Corporate Actions, and other investment banking operations. This role helped me develop a solid understanding of capital markets and investment banking processes. Currently, I am working as a Senior Banking Alliance Executive at Primasoft Technology EST in Dubai. My responsibilities include merchant onboarding, KYC verification, compliance checks, banking partner coordination, payment gateway operations, and supporting banking alliance activities. To strengthen my domain knowledge, I completed a Certification in Investment Banking Operations from Imarticus Learning, where I gained knowledge of the Trade Life Cycle, AML/KYC, Derivatives, and Capital Markets. Alongside my professional experience, I have developed strong skills in Microsoft Excel, Power BI, VBA Macro automation, MIS reporting, dashboard development, data analysis, and Mail Merge automation. I have also built multiple Power BI dashboards across different industries to strengthen my analytical thinking and Business Intelligence skills. Now, I am looking for an opportunity where I can combine my Banking and FinTech operations experience with Business Intelligence and data analytics to help organizations make better business decisions, improve operational efficiency, and continue growing professionally.

EXAMPLE

Delivery tip: begin calmly, slightly increase energy when describing Cameo and your current role, then finish strongly on the value you want to create in your next role.

2. Tell me about yourself - short interview introduction (30-45 seconds).

ANSWER

I have around five years of experience across operations and banking-related processes, including payment gateway operations, insurance-related operations and investment banking. Alongside my professional work, I independently developed data analytics skills using Power BI, DAX, Excel, data modelling and other analytical tools. I also use AI tools to improve productivity, analysis and problem solving. Now I am looking for an opportunity where I can combine my operations and domain experience with analytics and technology to create better business insights and solutions.

EXAMPLE

Use this version when the interviewer asks for a quick introduction, during recruiter screening, networking, or when time is limited.

3. Tell me about yourself.

ANSWER

I am an Investment Banking, Banking and FinTech Operations professional with experience across capital-markets operations, corporate actions, IPO/rights/buyback processing, settlement and reconciliation, merchant onboarding, KYC/AML and payment-gateway operations. I also use Power BI, Power Query, Advanced Excel and VBA to improve operational reporting and controls.

EXAMPLE

A 60-90 second answer can connect current banking-alliance work, earlier RTA/capital-markets experience and analytics capability.

● Situation



● Responsibility



● Action / Control



● Outcome

4. Walk me through your current role as Senior Banking Alliance Executive.

ANSWER

I manage operational and business reporting for banking alliances, merchant onboarding, KYC verification, compliance review and payment-gateway activities. I coordinate with banks, PSPs, TSPs, merchants and internal teams, validate documentation and use analytics/automation to improve visibility and activation timelines.

EXAMPLE

Example: reviewing a merchant file for completeness, resolving missing partner requirements, then updating MIS/dashboard status until activation.

5. What KYC work do you perform in your current role?

ANSWER

I review merchant and partner documentation for completeness, accuracy, regulatory alignment and internal-policy compliance before submission or activation. I also track documentation status and support resolution of onboarding issues.

EXAMPLE

Example: identifying a mismatch in legal name or bank proof and coordinating corrected documentation before activation.

6. How do you coordinate with banks, PSPs and TSPs?

ANSWER

I gather requirements, validate information, track dependencies, follow up on operational issues and support payment-system integration and merchant activation.

EXAMPLE

Example: a PSP requests additional merchant documents; I coordinate with the merchant, validate the response and update the partner.

7. Describe your experience in IPO and corporate-action operations.

ANSWER

At Cameo Corporate Services I supported end-to-end RTA/capital-markets operations covering IPOs, Rights Issues, Buybacks, Open Offers, Listing Offers, Call Money and Corporate Actions. My work included data validation, technical rejection support, allotment-related records, reconciliation and stakeholder coordination.

EXAMPLE

Example: validating exchange bid data against bank final certificates and internal records before allotment/settlement processing.

8. What did you reconcile in your RTA role?

ANSWER

I performed banking, settlement and transaction reconciliation and investigated mismatches between operational data, bank information and issue-processing records.

EXAMPLE

Example: tracing a difference between transaction records and bank final certificate totals before final processing.

9. How did you use BSE/NSE data?

ANSWER

I processed and validated bid, transaction and operational data from BSE/NSE against bank final certificates, schedule data and internal records to support accurate allotment, non-allotment and settlement processing.

EXAMPLE

Example: checking whether exchange bid totals and bank-certified funds aligned before downstream allotment steps.

● Situation



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10. What are technical rejection reports?

ANSWER

In issue processing, technical rejection reports identify applications that fail defined validation or eligibility rules. My role included helping prepare and validate these reports and related issue-processing data.

EXAMPLE

Example: a bid record with invalid or inconsistent data may be excluded from allotment according to applicable rules.

11. How did you support regulatory reporting?

ANSWER

I supported preparation and validation of data required for SEBI, stock-exchange and other operational/regulatory submissions, focusing on completeness and accuracy.

EXAMPLE

Example: reconciling report totals to source data before the submission was finalized.

12. How did you handle investor/customer queries?

ANSWER

I reviewed transaction and reconciliation data, checked relevant records, coordinated with internal teams where necessary and provided responses consistent with process status and available evidence.

EXAMPLE

Example: investigating why an application did not receive allotment by checking issue-processing records.

13. What KYC experience did you gain at CAMS?

ANSWER

I performed KYC checks, customer-record updates, bank-detail verification, penny-drop validation and final quality review across repository operations.

EXAMPLE

Example: verifying customer bank details and using penny-drop validation before final approval.

14. Explain penny-drop validation from your experience.

ANSWER

Penny-drop validation is a small-value bank-account check used to help verify that an account is valid and the returned account-name information matches expectations. In my role it supported bank-detail verification and quality review.

EXAMPLE

Example: if returned account-holder details do not match the customer record, the case is held for correction.

15. How do you use Power BI in banking operations?

ANSWER

I build operational dashboards to monitor KPIs, transaction trends, success/failure patterns, partner performance and failure reasons, turning raw operational data into management-ready views.

EXAMPLE

Example: a payment-gateway dashboard showing Total Transactions, Success Rate, PSP performance and recurring failure reasons.

16. What problem did your Payment Gateway Operations Dashboard solve?

ANSWER

It centralized operational monitoring across transaction volume, success/failure patterns, PSP/bank performance, merchant performance and failure reasons, making issues easier to identify and prioritize.

EXAMPLE

Example: repeated failures from one PSP can be isolated quickly instead of reviewing raw files manually.

● Situation



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17. What KPIs do you track in payment-gateway operations?

ANSWER

Examples from my project include Total Transactions, Successful Transactions, Failed Transactions, Success Rate, Daily Trends, PSP Performance, Bank Performance and Failure-Reason Analysis.

EXAMPLE

Example: a sudden drop in success rate can be drilled down by bank or PSP.

18. How do you ensure data accuracy in dashboards?

ANSWER

I validate source data, reconcile totals, check transformation logic, use controlled data models and compare KPI outputs with known operational reports before publishing.

EXAMPLE

Example: Total Transactions in Power BI is reconciled against the source operational file for the same period.

19. How have you automated MIS reporting?

ANSWER

I use Power Query, Advanced Excel and VBA to reduce repetitive preparation, standardize transformations and generate dashboards or periodic reports more efficiently.

EXAMPLE

Example: a recurring file-cleaning and consolidation task can be automated before dashboard refresh.

20. What is your strongest domain area?

ANSWER

My strongest combined area is operations control across capital markets and payments: validation, reconciliation, stakeholder coordination, KYC/onboarding and MIS. I can connect transaction-level processing with management reporting.

EXAMPLE

Example: resolving an operational mismatch and then reflecting its status/impact in the reporting dashboard.

21. Why are you suitable for a securities-operations role?

ANSWER

My background includes capital-markets issue processing, corporate actions, settlement, reconciliation, operational controls and a formal investment-banking certification covering securities, derivatives, trade life cycle, AML/KYC and settlement/reconciliation.

EXAMPLE

Example: I already understand both process execution and control functions such as reconciliation and exception handling.

22. Why are you suitable for a banking/FinTech operations role?

ANSWER

My current experience includes banking alliances, merchant onboarding, payment-gateway operations, KYC verification and partner coordination, supported by analytics and automation skills.

EXAMPLE

Example: coordinating a merchant from documentation review through partner activation while tracking the process in MIS.

● Situation



● Responsibility



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● Outcome

23. What would you say if asked about direct derivatives operations experience?

ANSWER

I would be transparent: my direct professional experience is stronger in capital-markets/RTA, settlement/reconciliation, banking and payments, while my derivatives knowledge comes from formal Investment Banking coursework and continued study. I can explain the concepts and operational lifecycle without overstating hands-on exposure.

EXAMPLE

Example: explain IRS lifecycle and collateral concepts, then clearly distinguish academic knowledge from work experience.

24. How do you handle operational exceptions?

ANSWER

I first validate the exception against source data, determine whether it is a timing difference, data issue or true processing error, identify ownership, coordinate resolution, document status and ensure the final records reconcile.

EXAMPLE

Example: a bank/transaction mismatch is traced to a missing posting and resolved before report closure.

25. Describe a time you improved a process.

ANSWER

A strong answer from my profile is to discuss automating MIS or dashboard preparation using Power Query, Excel/VBA or Power BI, reducing manual handling and improving visibility. Use real measurable results if available and do not invent numbers.

EXAMPLE

Example: replacing repeated manual file consolidation with a reusable Power Query workflow.

26. How do you prioritize multiple urgent operational issues?

ANSWER

I prioritize based on financial/regulatory risk, settlement or activation deadlines, customer impact, ageing and dependency. I keep stakeholders updated and track unresolved items until closure.

EXAMPLE

Example: a settlement exception near market cut-off takes priority over a routine MIS formatting change.

27. How do you manage stakeholder communication?

ANSWER

I keep requests specific, validate facts before escalation, assign ownership, track deadlines and provide concise status updates to banks, PSPs, merchants and internal teams.

EXAMPLE

Example: a missing document is communicated with exact requirement and due date rather than a generic "KYC pending" message.

28. What is your experience with corporate actions beyond basic dividends?

ANSWER

My resume includes Rights Issues, Buybacks, Open Offers, Listing Offers and other corporate-action/RTA operations, so I can discuss processing, data validation, reconciliation and issue-related coordination.

EXAMPLE

Example: rights-issue data requires accurate application/bid processing and downstream reconciliation.

● Situation



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29. How would you explain your career progression?

ANSWER

My progression moved from operations and KYC quality review at CAMS, to deeper capital-markets/RTA operations at Cameo, and then to banking alliances, merchant onboarding and payment-gateway operations, while expanding analytics and automation capability.

EXAMPLE

Example: each role added a broader layer - data quality, securities operations, then banking/FinTech coordination.

30. What is the link between your operations and analytics skills?

ANSWER

I use analytics as an operational-control tool, not as a separate discipline: dashboards help identify trends, failures, backlog, partner performance and reconciliation issues.

EXAMPLE

Example: failure-reason analysis can reveal a recurring bank-side issue requiring operational escalation.

31. What is your experience with reconciliation?

ANSWER

My resume shows banking, settlement and transaction reconciliation in capital-markets operations, plus quality checks and data validation in other roles.

EXAMPLE

Example: compare internal issue records with bank-certified totals and investigate mismatches before closure.

32. What is your experience with regulatory alignment?

ANSWER

I have reviewed merchant/partner documentation for regulatory/internal-policy alignment and supported data validation for SEBI/stock-exchange reporting in capital-markets operations.

EXAMPLE

Example: ensuring source totals and required fields are correct before regulatory/operational submission.

33. How do you explain your Investment Banking certification?

ANSWER

I completed Certified Investment Banking Professional coursework covering Securities & Derivatives, Trade Life Cycle, AML/KYC, Settlement & Reconciliation, Asset Management and Risk Management.

EXAMPLE

Example: use the certification to support conceptual knowledge, then connect it to settlement/reconciliation and corporate-action experience.

34. What is one gap you are currently strengthening?

ANSWER

A safe answer is to identify a role-relevant area where you have conceptual but less direct hands-on exposure, such as OTC derivatives processing, and explain how you are strengthening it through structured study and scenario practice.

EXAMPLE

Example: "I am deepening practical understanding of ISDA/CSA and collateral workflows using case-based exercises."

Situation



Responsibility



Action / Control



Outcome

35. Why should we hire you?

ANSWER

I combine hands-on operations experience across capital markets, banking and FinTech with strong control orientation and analytics capability. I can investigate exceptions, coordinate stakeholders and translate operational data into actionable reporting.

EXAMPLE

Example: I can both resolve a merchant or settlement issue and build the MIS that helps management track recurring causes.

36. What are your Power BI strengths?

ANSWER

My resume lists DAX, Power Query, data modeling, star schema, KPI development, data visualization and dashboard development. I use these for operational and financial analytics.

EXAMPLE

Example: build a star-schema model for transactions, merchants, PSPs and dates to analyze success rate by multiple dimensions.

37. What would you say about SQL?

ANSWER

I would describe SQL as a basic skill because that is how it appears on my resume, and I would avoid overstating proficiency. I can discuss basic querying concepts if asked.

EXAMPLE

Example: use SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY and simple joins for operational data extraction.

38. How do you ensure documentation quality?

ANSWER

I check completeness, data consistency, validity, approval requirements and alignment with the receiving bank/partner or internal policy before submission.

EXAMPLE

Example: confirm company name, registration details, UBO information and bank proof all match before onboarding submission.

39. What is your experience in quality control?

ANSWER

At CAMS I performed final quality review; at Cameo I validated transaction, bid and reconciliation data; in my current role I review documentation before submission/activation.

EXAMPLE

Example: detecting a bank-detail mismatch before it becomes a downstream payment issue.

40. How would you answer a question about managing more than 75 issues/transactions?

ANSWER

Use only the exact number if it is true and supported by your experience. Explain the variety of IPOs, rights issues, buybacks or other issues handled, your responsibilities and controls rather than focusing only on volume.

EXAMPLE

Example: "I supported numerous issue-processing events, validating data, reconciliation and operational reports across IPOs, rights issues and buybacks."

● Situation



● Responsibility



● Action / Control



● Outcome

41. What is your experience with MIS?

ANSWER

I have prepared daily, weekly and periodic MIS, campaign reports, operational summaries, KPI reports and dashboards across multiple roles.

EXAMPLE

Example: daily operational report highlighting pending items, exceptions and trend movement.

42. What types of interview questions should you avoid exaggerating?

ANSWER

Avoid claiming direct trading, investment advice, formal AML reporting authority, derivatives collateral management or regulatory decision-making unless you actually performed those duties. Be precise about “supported”, “validated”, “coordinated” and “performed”.

EXAMPLE

Example: say “I supported SEBI/stock-exchange reporting data validation” rather than “I was the regulatory reporting officer.”